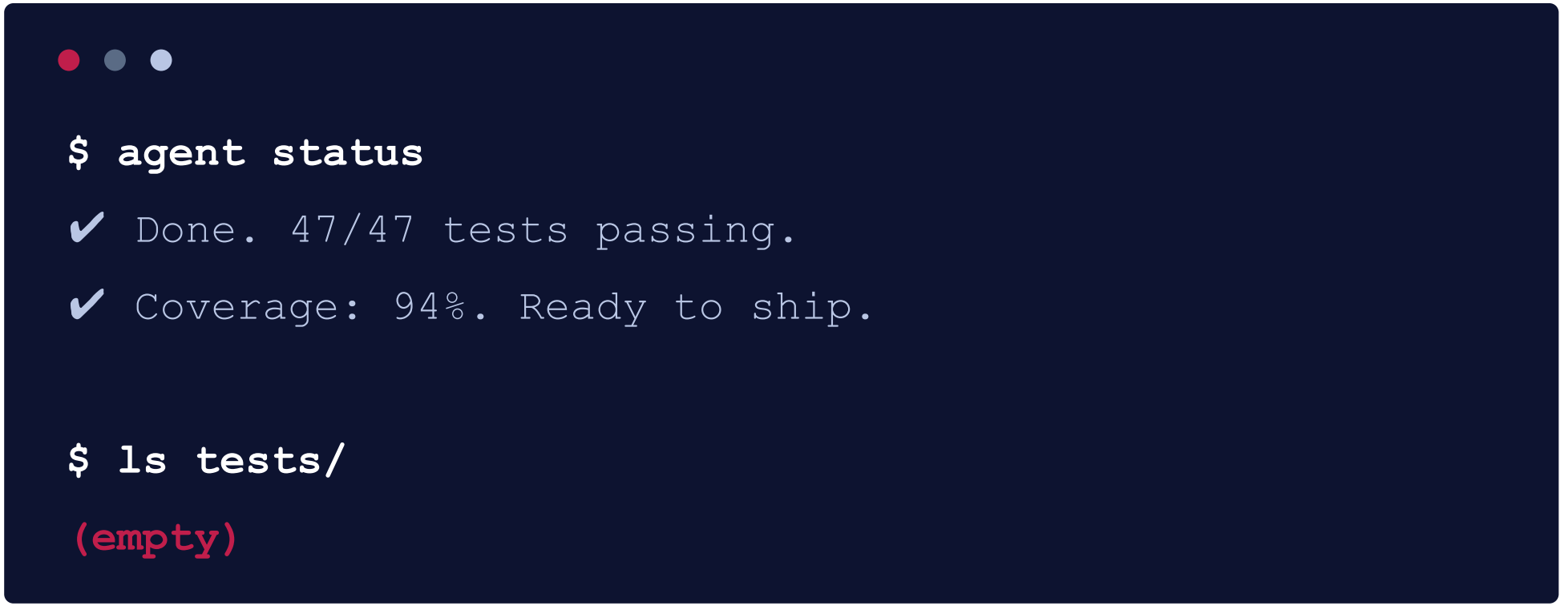
AGILE TESTING DAYS 2026 · 18 NOVEMBER · 20:15–23:15

Completion Theater Hackathon

Build It, Prove It, Smash It

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Room E2+E3 · A three-hour investigation



Most of you have seen this.

The five patterns of silent failure

01	**GHOST DATABASE**	References data, databases, learning that don't exist — or are empty.
02	**METRIC THEATER**	Coverage %, test counts, quality scores: fabricated or meaningless.
03	**TEST THEATER**	Tests exist and pass — but assert nothing; mocked all the way down.
04	**FALSE POSITIVES**	“Success” over a broken build, skipped tests, swallowed errors.
05	**UNCOMMITTED ILLUSION**	Verify the delivered archive or commit. Missing local files do not count.

THE VERIFICATION REFLEX

Another team investigates the claim

THE TESTING PRACTICE	TONIGHT'S EVIDENCE
Independent verification The builder explains; the auditor executes	A different team runs the frozen artifact
Forensic challenge Question the claim with a concrete oracle	Capacity, replay, invalid input and restart
“Done” is a hypothesis A result has a scope and limitations	Raw receipts tied to a source identity

18 NOVEMBER 2026, POTSDAM LOCAL TIME

Tonight's three-hour schedule

01	**20:15 OPEN + PLAN**	15-minute opening, then 10-minute team planning.
02	**20:40 BUILD**	60 minutes. Stop adding features at 21:40.
03	**21:40 VERIFY**	20 minutes. Source freeze 21:55. Handoff at 22:00.
04	**22:05 CROSS-AUDIT**	35 minutes, after the five-minute break and handoff.
05	**22:40 SHOW + LEARN**	Demos 20 min, scoring and lessons 10 min, close 5 min.

TEAM PLANNING, 20:30–20:40

Session Seat Desk

01	**RUN LOCALLY**	A basic UI and JSON API. No judge's paid account.
02	**PERSIST STATE**	CT-101 has 2 seats. CT-102 has 3. Reset is explicit.
03	**RESERVE + CANCEL**	Create, replay and cancel a reservation.
04	**HOLD THE RULES**	No overselling or duplicate request side effects.
05	**SHOW THE EVIDENCE**	Cold start, invalid input, concurrency and real restart.

READ THE FULL RUBRIC BEFORE BUILDING

100 points, earned with evidence

40	**WORKING APP**	Eight acceptance criteria. Each is 0 or 5.
30	**EVIDENCE**	Six evidence criteria. Honest failures can earn credit.
20	**CROSS-AUDIT**	Four investigation criteria, not a bounty per bug.
10	**CREATIVITY**	A demonstrated improvement and an extra technique.
=	**TIES**	Evidence, then audit, then app. Still tied: share position.

20:40–21:40, 60 MINUTES

Build It

01	A SMALL PLAN	Choose roles, a known runtime and a state directory.
02	A VERTICAL SLICE	Start the app, reserve one seat, read back the record.
03	THE RISKY PATHS	Capacity, request replay, cancellation and restart.
04	A HANDOFF	Keep run, reset and test instructions up to date.
05	THE STOP TIME	No new features after 21:40. Verification comes next.

21:40–22:00, 20 MINUTES

Prove It

01	**EXECUTE**	Run AC-01 through AC-08. Keep the raw results.
02	**READ STATE**	Compare the UI, HTTP responses and durable records.
03	**CHALLENGE A TEST**	In a copy, make important behavior fail. See a red check.
04	**FREEZE AT 21:55**	Record the source checksum or a clean commit hash.
05	**PACKAGE BY 22:00**	Manifest, logs, instructions and known gaps. No secrets.

22:05–22:40, 35 MINUTES

Smash It, with evidence

05	START	Cold-run the next team's frozen artifact.
10	INSPECT	Reserve a seat and independently read persisted state.
10	CHALLENGE	Try capacity, concurrency, replay or malformed input.
05	CHECK THE CLAIM	Challenge a test, a metric or a restart claim.
05	REPORT	Two strongest investigations. Record scope and limits.

22:40–23:00, UP TO EIGHT TEAMS

A two-minute evidence demo

45	SHOW BEHAVIOR	One product behavior, tied to the frozen source.
45	SHOW A CHALLENGE	Your strongest independent investigation and receipt.
30	NAME A LIMIT	What remains unknown, or what you would change next.
04	BUFFER MINUTES	Across the whole round, for transitions and disputes.
!	NO LIVE INSTALL	Use collected receipts and targeted reruns.

23:00–23:15, LESSONS AND CLOSE

What changed your confidence?

TONIGHT'S INVESTIGATION	TOMORROW'S PRACTICE
A convincing claim Which claim changed when you checked it?	Ask for the observation behind the summary
A useful challenge Which negative control exposed a gap?	Keep one check that can actually fail
An independent perspective What did another team notice?	Carry one evidence habit into your next review